

Agnieszka Besz

engineering & technology leader — games & real-time systems

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about

I've spent more than a decade building games and the teams behind them — from live mobile titles to a large, open-source 3D social platform. Along the way I stopped thinking of the job as just engineering and started running it like a business: I own the strategy and the budget, negotiate the engine and vendor contracts, and care as much about getting the product into people's hands as about the code underneath. I led a full ground-up rebuild of our client and grew the team from a handful of engineers into a real organisation with its own managers and QA. But the part I care about most isn't the tech — it's the people building it: I give them clarity, clear the obstacles, hire people better than me, and trust them. I lead with data over opinion, keep things simple, use AI as a real part of how we work, and I still read the code.

work experience

VP of Engineering — Decentraland, London

2025 – Present

- Led the ground-up rebuild of the client — replacing the legacy web client with a new modular, open-source desktop client, now the platform's primary client in production.
- Set technical direction, strategy, and OKRs, data-first — telemetry decides what we build, cut, and prioritize.
- Owned the technology budget and led engine licensing/contract negotiations with Unity.
- Expanded distribution: Epic Games Store, code-signed Windows builds, and launcher/onboarding reliability.
- Scaled from a single ~5-engineer team to multiple teams with engineering managers and QA leads; built the hiring process, career ladder, and performance-management cadence.
- Built AI into the engineering process (AI review on every PR, AI-assisted QA), drove adoption across teams, and use it daily in my own analysis.
- Shipped ~75 public builds/year (weekly-or-faster): terrain/LOD rendering, a major engine upgrade, a server-authoritative CRDT, hang detection with crash reporting, and automated performance tests gating every PR.

Engineering Manager — Decentraland, London

2022 – 2025

- Grew and led the client team from ~5 to 10+ engineers; led the rebuild that replaced the legacy web client and stood up the new desktop client's architecture.
- Drove the client's strategic KPIs — loading time, stability, frame rate — and the tech-debt program behind them.
- Rebuilt how the team shipped: predictable cadence, monitoring, and a QA bar every build had to clear.

Head of Frontend Development — Ten Square Games

2021 – 2022

- Engineering leadership for a 45+ person technology department across seven live game teams.
- Scaled the department from ~25 to 45+ engineers during a major growth phase.
- Modernized lifecycle tooling and drove adoption of shared libraries — faster iteration for every team.

Technical Manager — Rovio (now Sega), Helsinki

2019 – 2021

- Led development of Angry Birds Journey from concept to soft launch, and the programming team behind it; mentored and grew the team.

Senior Game Programmer — Next Games (now Netflix), Helsinki

2017 – 2019

- Stranger Things: Puzzle Tales and The Walking Dead: No Man's Land (Android/iOS) — core game systems, new mechanics, and live-ops engineering.

Associate Lead Programmer → Programmer — Ubisoft RedLynx, Helsinki

2015 – 2017

- South Park: Phone Destroyer (real-time synchronous PvP, Android/iOS) — built core systems, multiplayer, AI, UI; led performance optimization and a team of programmers.

Earlier roles

2012 – 2015

- Turku University of Applied Sciences — Lecturer / Project Engineer; INTERMARUM — Programmer (shipped Leisure Suit Larry: Reloaded); Kiwi Flying Mad — Programmer & Co-founder of an indie studio.

education

Doctoral studies (not completed), Computer Science — Turku & Opole Univ. of Technology (2013 – 2015)

MSc, Computer Science — Opole University of Technology (2012 – 2013)

BSc, Computer Science — Opole University of Technology (2008 – 2012); exchange year at Vaasa UAS, Finland

leadership

- Strategy & OKRs
- Budget & cost ownership
- Vendor & partner management
- Cross-functional leadership
- Distribution / go-to-market
- Org design, hiring & performance mgmt

technical

- Real-time multiplayer & rendering
- Performance optimization
- QA & release engineering
- Live operations
- AI in engineering workflows
- Unity / C#, architecture

tools

- Unity / C#
- Git & GitHub CI/CD
- Sentry, Grafana
- Jira, Notion, Slack

languages

- Polish (native)
- English (professional)
- Finnish (elementary)

recognition

DirectX 11 Competition

Best Pitch — Startup Journey Demo Day

3 publications (mobile AR, driving-inspection tooling, shooting-sports apps)